How money works in Orion

Revenue, costs, the bank and the dashboards, step by step.

Knowledge transfer for Prakash Securities



The whole answer on one page



Revenue is only ever a bill

The taxable value of issued bills, before GST and less credit notes, in the month the service was for. A bank entry is never revenue.



Cost is expenses plus salary

Margin = Revenue − Expenses − Payroll. Fleet is shown on its own tab and is not in the margin.



Cash is a different question

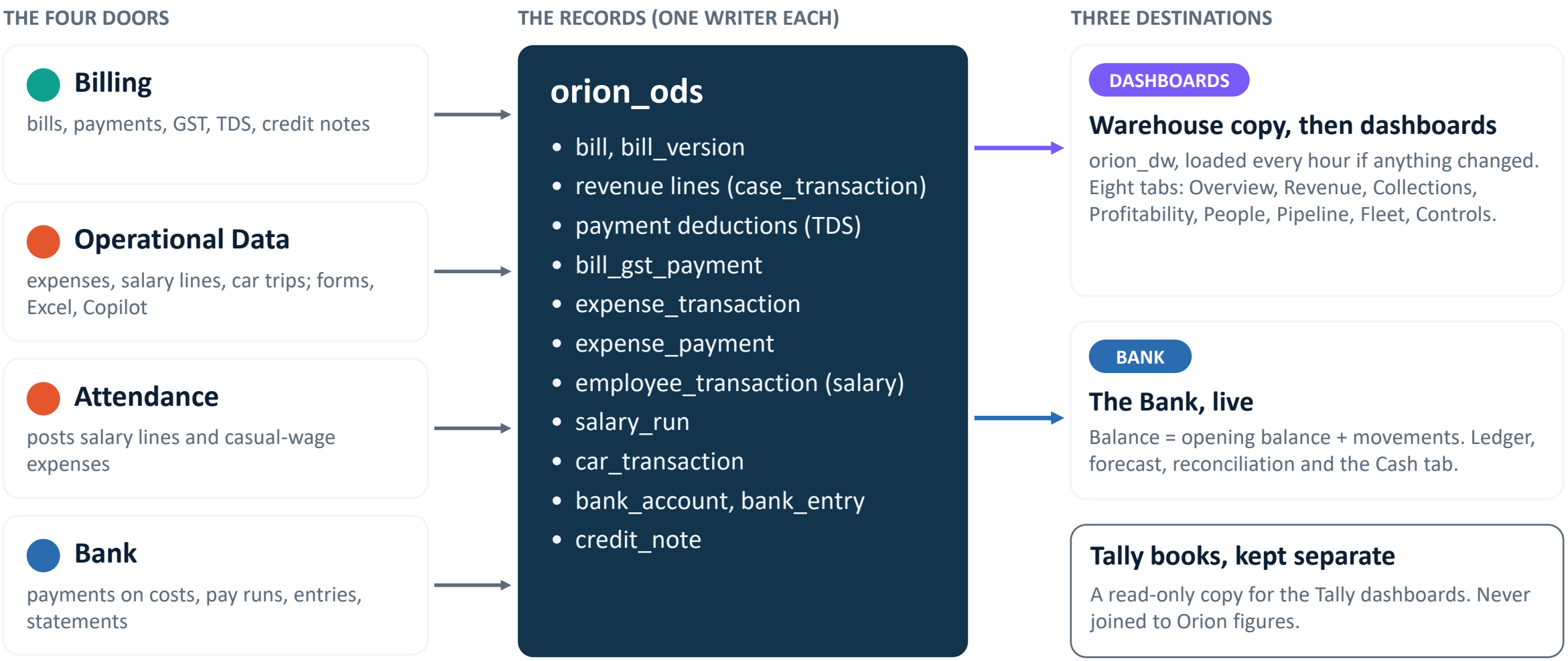
What was actually received and paid, with GST. It lives in the Bank and on the Collections tab.



Dashboards read a copy

The warehouse is refreshed within the hour, only when something changed. Bank screens read the live records.

The big picture: doors, records, and three destinations



Revenue

Where it comes from, how it is collected, and what is not revenue.

Revenue starts with a bill

1

Pick case, lines

A billing user picks the case, fills lines (quantity × rate), charges and GST rates.

2

Server recalculates

compute_bill works out every figure. The screen preview is tested against the same 73 figures.

3

Number is taken

FY/seq (for example 2026-27/66) from a locked counter. Never reused, never changed.

4

Bill and revenue line

One bill (version 1) and one revenue line are written together, in one transaction.

5

Saved once

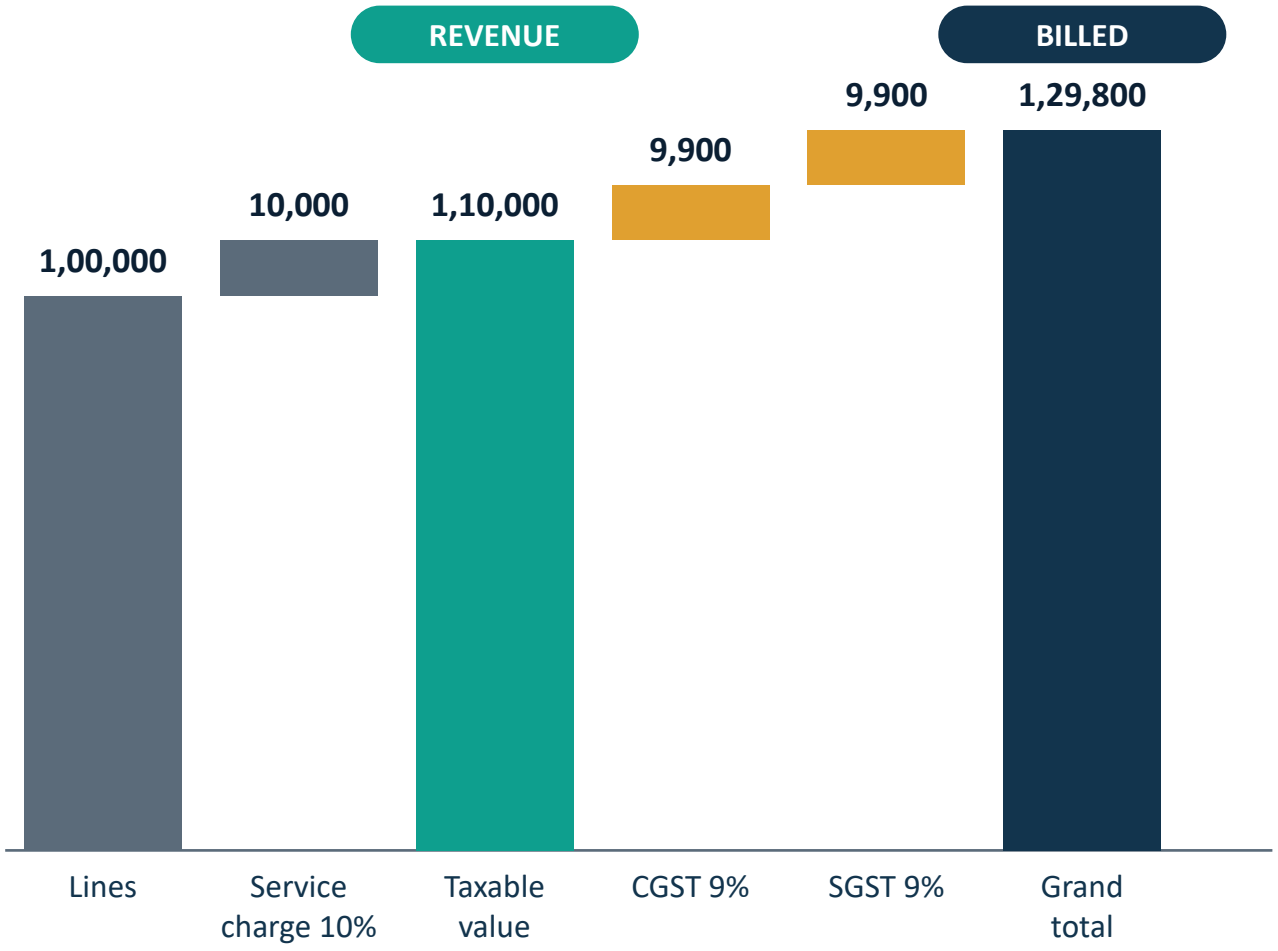
An Idempotency-Key is claimed in the same transaction, so a retry cannot raise a second bill.

THE REVENUE LINE case_transaction, written only by billing.py

status	transaction_date	transaction_amount	gst	amount_after_tax_gst
Prospective (still to receive)	the bill date	the taxable value	CGST + SGST	the grand total

A bill has at most one Prospective line, and its lines always add up to its grand total.

What a bill is made of: taxable value is revenue



How the server builds it

Lines total quantity × rate, summed

+ EPFO % and **ESIC %** of lines total

+ Service charge % of lines total

+ named extra charges (a percentage or a fixed amount)

= Taxable value is Revenue

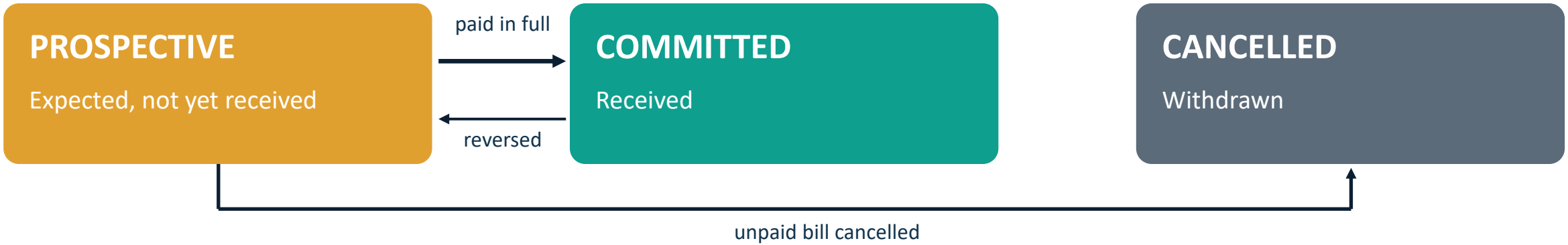
+ CGST % and SGST % of taxable value

± round-off to the rupee, shown on the bill

= Grand total is Billed

The browser preview (billCalc.ts) and the server (compute_bill) are tested against the same 73 figures.

The life of a revenue line



Part payment: this line shrinks, and a new Committed line is added for the money received.

	Counts in the bank balance	In the forecast	On the dashboards
Prospective	No	Yes, on its date	Shows as Owed
Committed	Yes, the cash only (less any TDS held back)	No	Cash collected, Settled, TDS held back
Cancelled	No	No	Leakage on the Controls tab

A Committed (received) line must belong to a bill: a database trigger refuses it otherwise. Money with no bill is a Bank entry.

When the client pays: in full, in part, or net of TDS

PAYS IN FULL

Everything still open is paid.

- The Prospective line becomes Committed.
- received_date is set.
- The bank balance goes up by the cash.
- The bill reads Paid.

PAYS PART

A part of what is open is paid.

- A new Committed line is made for the money in.
- The Prospective line shrinks; tax and GST are split in proportion.
- The bill stays open for the rest.
- Any number of part payments.

PAYS NET OF TDS

Cash 1,27,600 + TDS 2,200 = 1,29,800.

- The bill closes: settled by cash plus what was held back.
- The deduction is kept (section, rate), never deleted.
- The bank sees only the cash, 1,27,600.
- TDS waits in Utility > TDS to be ticked against Form 26AS.

Settled = cash + deductions. A payment is reversed only by an admin, with a reason. The row stays, with who, when and why.

Correcting a bill after it is issued

Edit

- Needs a reason; keeps the number.
- The old bill is copied whole into bill_version.
- The open revenue line is rewritten to match.
- Cannot go below what was already received.

Cancel

- Only an unpaid bill.
- GST payments must be reversed first.
- Its revenue line becomes Cancelled and drops out of every figure.
- The number stays on record.

Credit note or write-off

- Takes money off what is still owed, with its revenue and GST.
- Made, then approved by another person or an admin; a write-off by an admin only.
- Numbered CN FY/seq on approval; reversed only by an admin.
- The bill itself is unchanged.

An issued bill number never changes and is never reused, not even after cancelling.

GST: collected inside the bill, owed, then paid

1

Bill raised

CGST and SGST are worked out on the taxable value.

2

Client pays the total

The GST is inside the receipt, so the bank receives taxable value + GST.

3

GST owed on the bill

Shown as GST to pay, less any credit note. Forecast: the 20th of next month.

4

GST payment recorded

CGST and/or SGST, a day, a reference. Any number of instalments.

5

Bank money out

One movement per payment batch, on the day paid.

Controls on a GST payment

- A confirmation naming the bill and its total.
- The amount already paid, as the person saw it (seen_paid): two people cannot both record it.
- No more than is left on each component; not in the future.
- Reversed only with a reason; the row is kept.

Input tax credit (Utility > GST)

- An expense with GST must carry the supplier's GSTIN and invoice number for the credit to count.
- Net GST to pay = GST on bills − input credit, month by month; a surplus carries forward.
- Not modelled: reverse charge, blocked credit, TCS, and filing the return (GSTR-3B).

Money in the bank that is not revenue

REVENUE

Issued bills only

Taxable value, before GST, less credit notes, in the month the service was for.

Reads fact_bill in the warehouse.

≠

BANK ENTRIES

Money with no record anywhere else in Orion

MONEY IN

Interest, other income, loans, refunds, owner capital, and money with no bill (an advance or deposit, with a required note saying who paid and why).

MONEY OUT

Bank charges, tax, PF and ESI, loan repayment, owner withdrawal, and GST paid outside a bill.

They reach: the bank balance, the Ledger and the Cash tab. Voided with a reason, never deleted.

Costs

Five doors by which a cost enters Orion, and how it is paid.

Five doors for a cost: three count in the margin

Expense

ENTERED

Data > Orion data > Expense Transaction: the form, an Excel upload, or the Copilot (after a confirmation).

ON THE DASHBOARDS

Expense: before GST, unless Cancelled.

IN THE MARGIN

Salary line

ENTERED

Employee Transaction, or created by posting an attendance register.

ON THE DASHBOARDS

Payroll: by month, paid or not.

IN THE MARGIN

Attendance

ENTERED

Utility > Attendance. Posting enters salary lines for employees and expenses for casual workers.

ON THE DASHBOARDS

Through the lines it enters.

IN THE MARGIN

Car trip

ENTERED

Car Transaction: odometer in and out, the car and the driver.

ON THE DASHBOARDS

Fleet tab: km × per-km price.

NOT IN THE MARGIN

Bank only

ENTERED

Bank > Ledger or a GST payment: charges, tax, PF/ESI, EMI, owner money, GST paid.

ON THE DASHBOARDS

Cash tab only.

NOT IN THE MARGIN

Margin = Revenue − Expense − Payroll

An expense: what is entered, and what each part does

Field	What it does
Case, Expense type	What it was for. With no case it counts under "Head office and unallocated".
Transaction date	The day it is dated. This sets the month on the dashboards.
Amount, Tax, GST, Total	Amount before GST, tax, GST and the total. The total must equal the sum, within a rupee.
Supplier GSTIN, invoice no	Both needed for the GST on it to count as input tax credit.
Pay by	The due day. Drives the forecast and the Payables ageing.
Regular expense	Yes or No: whether it recurs.

Entered by the form, by an Excel upload or by the Copilot after a confirmation. All go through one gate, entity_service.py.

INCURRED

Stored as Committed. A real cost, owed. It leaves the bank only when a payment is recorded.

PLANNED

Stored as Prospective. Expected, not yet happened. In the forecast; cannot be paid yet.

CANCELLED

Withdrawn. Drops out of every figure.

On the dashboards

Expense = every expense that is not Cancelled, before GST, by its date. A look-alike entry (same type, case and amount within a week) is warned about, never blocked.

Attendance: how a register becomes pay

The register

One case and one month, with a line for each person.

Amount = days present × rate + extra − deduction (never below zero)

Employee rate = monthly salary ÷ days in that month

Post

Needs the confirmation, the count and total the person saw, and an Idempotency-Key. Dated the last day of the month, or today if the month is not over.

EMPLOYEE

Employee: a salary line

employee_transaction: the month, days worked, the amount, the case, not paid.

CASUAL WORKER

Worker: an expense

expense_transaction: Incurred, the expense type chosen on the register, regular = Yes, not paid.

Paying stays where it is

Salary in Bank > Payroll (a pay run). Expenses in Bank > Payables. Posting moves no money.

Reopen to correct

Possible until anything it entered has been paid or had a payment recorded. The entries are taken back; post again.

The lines are locked

They carry attendance_line_id and the generic forms refuse to change them, so a register and its pay never disagree.

Salary: a line per employee per month, paid by a pay run

Salary line

- **Employee** and **month** (YYYY-MM)
- **Days worked**
- **Salary amount**
- **Salary paid**: No until a pay run pays it. Never typed in.
- **Case** it was worked at

Bank > Payroll: a pay run

- Tick the month's lines.
- The day, the account, the bank reference.
- The confirmation, and the count and total the person saw.
- An Idempotency-Key.

One bank movement

One movement per run, out, on the day paid, from the account named, for what its lines come to. One transfer on the statement matches one movement.

Reversal

Needs a reason. The lines go back to unpaid; the run is kept for ever.

A paid line is frozen

A database trigger stops a line in a run being changed or deleted.

On the dashboards

Payroll counts every line in its month. Salary pending = lines not yet paid.

Paying a cost: the only way it reaches the bank

EXPENSE

Incurred expense	→	Bank > Payables	→	expense_payment	→	Money out
Owed. Not in the bank yet.		An amount, a day, the account, a reference.		One row per payment, as many as it takes.		On the day paid. Reads Unpaid, Part paid or Paid.

SALARY

Salary lines	→	Bank > Payroll	→	salary_run	→	One movement
Not paid. Already counted as Payroll.		Tick the lines, the day, the account, a reference.		One pay run for the month.		One per run, so one transfer = one match.

Same controls on both: confirmation · the amount the person saw (seen_paid) · no more than is left · not in the future · not before the account's opening date · Idempotency-Key · reversal only with a reason, and the row is kept for ever.

The Bank

A balance that is calculated, never stored, and a way to prove it.

The bank balance is calculated, never stored

Opening balance

typed once, on a date

+ Movements

since the opening date

= Balance today

live, per account

Movement	Direction	Read from	Dated by
Client receipt	In	Committed revenue lines: the cash only, less anything held back	received date
Expense payment	Out	expense_payment, not reversed	day paid
Salary pay run	Out	salary_run, not reversed: one per run	day paid
GST paid	Out	bill_gst_payment, not reversed: one per batch	day paid
Bank entry	**In or out**	bank_entry, not voided	entry date

Forecast

A second view, bank_expected, holds what is known to be coming: open revenue lines, planned and unpaid expenses, unpaid salary at month end, and GST estimated for the 20th of next month. It feeds the 30, 60 and 90 day totals and a 13-week projection. Overdue money is left out unless the person ticks it in.

Reconciliation: proving the book against the bank

1

Upload

CSV or Excel statement, up to 20,000 lines.

2

Read and check

Finds the columns and dates; checks the running balance line to line.

3

Auto-match

Only when certain both ways. Otherwise the line waits.

4

A person decides

Match, record an entry from the line, set aside with a reason, or unmatch.

When a line is matched by itself

- Same direction and exactly the same amount, to the paisa.
- Within 5 days of the movement.
- Exactly one candidate, or one carries the bill number or reference on the line.
- No other line wants the same movement.
- A movement can be on one line at most (a database rule).

RECONCILED

Nothing is loose on either side.

DIFFERENCES EXPLAINED

The balances differ by exactly the loose items. Match or record them and the gap closes.

DOES NOT ADD UP

Something is missing that is neither a loose movement nor a loose line: often a wrong opening balance or an un-uploaded stretch.

From a record to a dashboard

The warehouse, the figures, and why screens can disagree.

The road to a dashboard figure

orion_ods

The records, written by the app. One writer for each kind of money record.

Hourly check

A fingerprint of the data (row counts, newest change per table, deletions) against the last load.

orion_dw

A versioned copy: dimensions and facts. Loads only if something changed.

The engine

dashboard/engine.py: one definition of each figure, and the filters.

Dashboard tabs

GET /api/dashboard/{tab}: figures, charts, findings, the rows behind them.

Versions, not overwrites

A changed row closes its current version and adds a new one (SCD Type 2). A deleted row is marked expired. Dashboards read only live versions.

As it was on the day

A fact carries the case, client, capability and domain as they were on its date. A client's state or type on a bill is that of the day it was raised.

How fresh

At most an hour behind. "Warehouse last loaded" shows the oldest table's load. Run it now from the ETL page. The Cash tab and Bank are live.

Which warehouse table feeds which figure

Scope	Warehouse table	The month is	Feeds
Bills	fact_bill	service month	Revenue, Billed, GST, Owed, ageing, DSO, credit notes
Revenue lines	fact_case_transaction	transaction date	Lines by status: Committed, Prospective, Cancelled
Collections	fact_case_transaction (Committed)	received date	Cash collected, Settled, TDS held back
Expenses	fact_expense_transaction	transaction date	Expense, input tax credit
Payroll	fact_employee_transaction	the salary month	Payroll, salary pending
Fleet	fact_car_transaction, dim_car	driving date	Kilometres, Fleet cost
Pipeline	dim_opportunity, fact_emd	start or deposit date	Tenders, win rate, EMD held
Rosters	dim_case, dim_employee, dim_contact	as they stand now	Cases, headcount, contacts

The Cash tab is the exception: it reads the Bank module live, only for people with bank access.

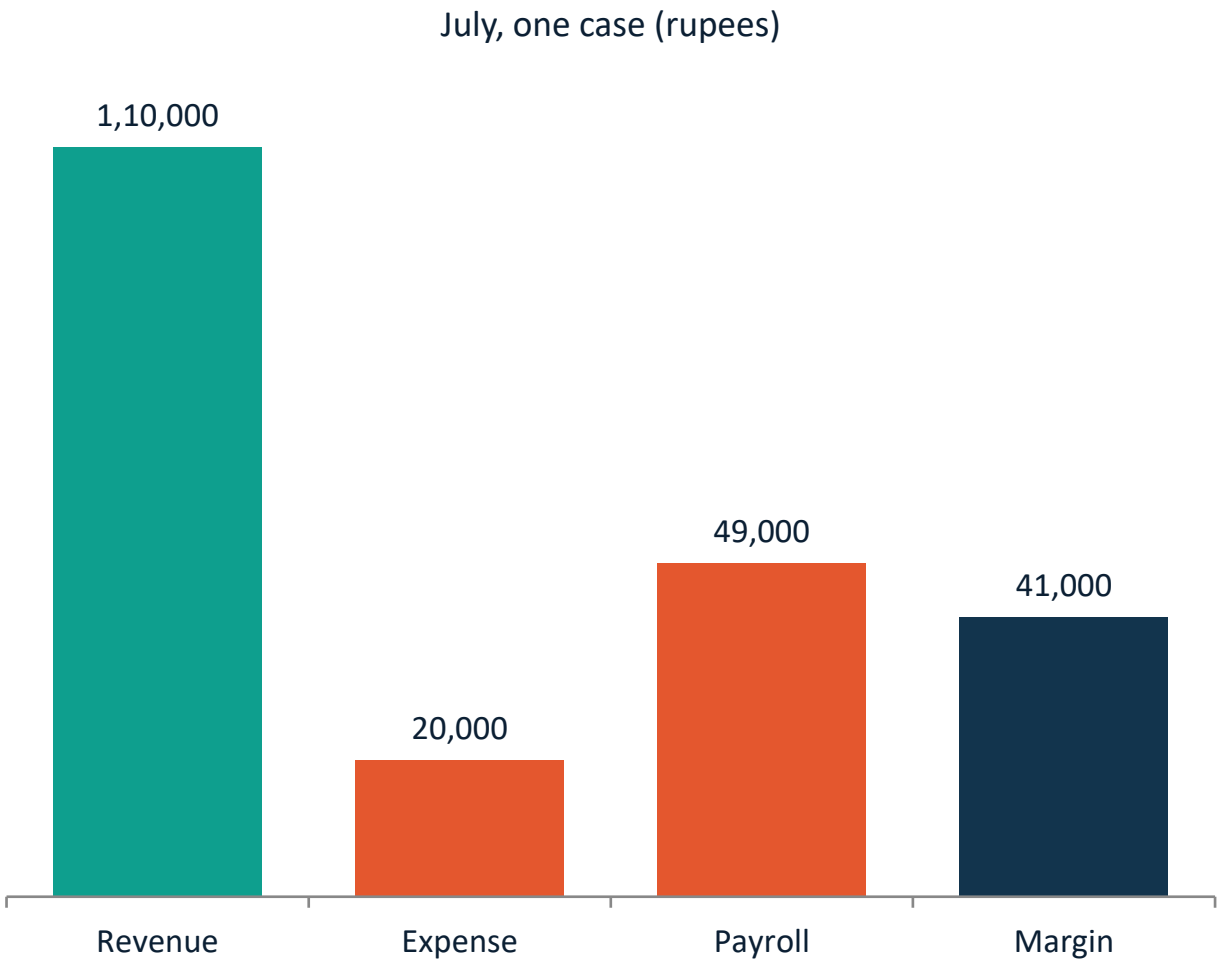
The money figures: revenue and cash

Figure	Exact meaning	Basis
Revenue	Taxable value of issued bills, less credit notes	Service month, before GST
Billed	Grand total of issued bills, less credit notes	Service month, with GST
GST on bills	CGST + SGST, less credited GST	Service month
Credit notes	Amount credited against bills	Service month
Cash collected	Committed payments, less what the client held back	Received date, with GST
Settled	Committed payments including what was held back	Received date
TDS held back	Deductions kept on the payments	Received date
Collection rate	Settled ÷ Billed, on the dimensions both carry	Ratio

The money figures: owed, cost and margin

Figure	Exact meaning	Basis
Outstanding (Owed)	Bill total − credit notes − settled; aged 0-30, 31-60, 61-90, 90+ from the bill date	Snapshot at the last load
DSO	Outstanding ÷ billed in the last 90 days × 90	Days of billing owed
Expense	Every expense that is not Cancelled, amount before GST	Transaction date
Payroll	Every salary line, paid or not	The salary month
Salary pending	Salary lines where paid is No	The salary month
Margin	**Revenue − Expense − Payroll**	Accrual
Margin %	Margin ÷ Revenue	Ratio
Input tax credit	GST on incurred expenses that carry the supplier GSTIN and invoice no	Transaction date
Net GST to pay	GST on bills − input tax credit; below zero is carried forward	Month

Margin: the hospital in July



The sum

Revenue 1,10,000 (the bill's taxable value)

– Expense 20,000 (casual wages 12,000 + uniforms 8,000)

– Payroll 49,000 (three salary lines)

= Margin 41,000 (37.3%)

Cash moving does not change it

Paying the salary, collecting the bill, paying the GST and earning interest all leave July's margin untouched. Margin moves only when a bill, an expense or a salary line is entered.

Why two screens can show different numbers

Compare	Why they differ
Revenue and Cash collected	Revenue is earned: by service month, before GST. Cash is received: by the day it came, with GST, less TDS held back.
Billed and Revenue	Billed includes GST and round-off. Revenue is the taxable value.
Expense and money out	Expense is dated by the cost, before GST, planned costs included. Money out is dated by the payment, with GST, plus GST paid, charges and other entries.
Payroll and salary paid	Payroll counts every line in its month. The bank sees salary only when a pay run is recorded.
Margin and the bank	Margin is accrual. It leaves out fleet, GST paid, bank charges, tax and loans.
Dashboards and Bank	Dashboards are as fresh as the last warehouse load. The Bank is live.
Orion and Tally	Tally is the accountant's books, a read-only copy. Orion never joins them into one number.

One hospital, one month: the whole journey

Day	What happens	Bank	Dashboards (after the next load)
31 Jul	Bill 2026-27/202 raised: 1,10,000 + GST 19,800 = 1,29,800	no change	Revenue +1,10,000. Billed +1,29,800. Owed +1,29,800
31 Jul	Attendance posted: 3 salary lines (49,000), 2 casual wages (12,000)	no change	Payroll +49,000. Expense +12,000
31 Jul	Uniform expense entered: 8,000 + GST 1,440	no change	Expense +8,000. Input credit +1,440
5 Aug	Salary pay run 49,000; casual wages and uniforms paid (21,440)	−70,440	Salary pending −49,000. Expense unchanged
12 Sep	Client pays 1,27,600; held back 2,200 TDS	+1,27,600	Cash collected +1,27,600. TDS held +2,200. Owed −1,29,800
20 Sep	GST of 19,800 paid	−19,800	GST unpaid −19,800
21 Sep	Bank interest credited	+ the interest	Cash tab only. Not revenue

Revenue and cost land when a bill, an expense or attendance is entered. Cash lands only when a payment, a pay run, a receipt or a GST payment is recorded.

What protects the money

One writer

Each kind of money record has exactly one piece of code that writes it.

The server recomputes

The customer is billed the server's figure, tested against 73 published figures.

Processed once

An Idempotency-Key claimed in the same transaction stops a double click or retry.

History, never overwrite

Bills are versioned; payments reversed; entries voided; nothing is deleted.

Confirm what you saw

Money acts carry the amount the person saw, so two people cannot both act.

Second pair of eyes

A credit note is approved by someone other than its maker, or an admin.

Who, when, why

created_by, last_updated_by, bill versions, bank audit, deleted-record log.

Access by flag

Bank access is admin-only by default. Every route checks its permission on the server.

What Orion does not do, said plainly

Not double-entry

No chart of accounts or trial balance. Tally stays the accounting book; nothing in Orion measures the gap between the two.

No month-end lock

A past bill, payment or expense can still be changed, with a reason, a version and an audit trail.

GST is not a return

Net GST is shown by month, but reverse charge, blocked credit, TCS and filing GSTR-3B are not modelled.

PF, ESI and dues

Not generated from salary lines. They are bank entries, or expenses if someone enters them.

Fleet and EMD

Fleet cost is not in margin. An EMD is not in the bank unless recorded as entries.

Statements by hand

No bank feed. Matching relies on amount, date and the text on the line.

An hour behind

Dashboards are as fresh as the last warehouse load. The Bank is live.

Questions the client will ask (1 of 2)

Where does revenue come from?

Only from issued bills: the taxable value, in the month the service was for.

Is bank interest revenue?

No. It is a bank entry: it shows in the Bank and the Cash tab, never in Revenue or Margin.

When the client pays, does revenue go up?

No. It went up when the bill was raised. Payment moves the bill from owed to settled and the bank balance up.

Where do costs come from?

Expenses, salary lines and attendance. Margin = Revenue − Expense − Payroll.

What happens when I post attendance?

Employees get salary lines; casual workers get expenses. Nothing is paid until a pay run or a payment is recorded.

Why did the bank not move when I entered an expense?

An expense is owed, not paid. The balance moves when the payment is recorded in Bank > Payables.

Questions the client will ask (2 of 2)

What is TDS in Orion?

What the client held back from a payment. The bill is settled by cash plus TDS; the bank sees the cash; TDS is tracked for Form 26AS.

Why is a number not what I just entered?

The dashboards read the warehouse, at most an hour behind. Run it now from the ETL page.

Can money be deleted?

No. Bills are versioned or cancelled, payments reversed, entries voided. Every row is kept with who and when.

Who can see the bank?

Only people given bank access (admins by default). The Cash tab and the Copilot check it too.

Does the Copilot change money?

It can create or edit operational records only after the person confirms. It cannot raise a bill, record a payment, a bank entry or a pay run.

Does Orion replace Tally?

No. Tally stays the accounting book. Orion is the operational record and reporting layer, with a read-only copy of Tally.

Where to look next

docs/kt-money-to-dashboards.md · docs/money-flow.md
docs/features.md · docs/change-impact.md